engineering, and medical sciences converse seamlessly. We must provide students with a holistic, global outlook while remaining deeply rooted in the practical socio-economic realities of our local community.

KBNU is uniquely structured as a comprehensive, multi-disciplinary university. Could you walk us through the diversity of disciplines and professional courses offered here?

KBNU was consciously designed to break down the rigid boundaries of conventional education. We currently govern multiple distinct faculties offering undergraduate, postgraduate, and doctoral (Ph.D.) programmes.

Our Faculty of Medical Sciences – anchored by the flagship Khaja Bandanawaz Institute of Medical Sciences – offers the MBBS degree alongside specialised MS tracks in fields such as General Surgery, Ophthalmology, Orthopaedics, ENT and OBG and MD courses in Anatomy, Physiology, Biochemistry, Pathology, Pharmacology, Microbiology, Community Medicine, General Medicine, Dermatology, Anaesthesiology, Radio diagnosis and Paediatrics, supplemented by allied health streams like Medical Laboratory Technology and Optometry.

For technical minds, the Faculty of Engineering and Technology provides exceptional B.Tech and M.Tech tracks. We are a pioneer in Karnataka, offering high-growth fields like Aeronautical Engineering, Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning, Data Science, and Geoinformatics alongside core branches like Computer Science, Mechanical, and Civil Engineering.

Besides, our Faculty of Sciences offers rich research options in Biotechnology, Food & Nutrition, and Chemistry. This is complemented by vibrant corporate programmes under the Faculty of Commerce & Management (including an MBA in Hospital Administration), the Faculty of Law, the Faculty of Education (B.Ed), and the Faculty of Arts, Humanities & Social Sciences, which provides specialised training in Mass Communication and Media. We truly offer a pathway for every professional aspiration.

With the global employment market shifting rapidly, how does KBNU ensure its graduates remain competitive and industry-ready?

We have entirely restructured our pedagogy to prioritise practical, experiential learning over rote memorisation. For instance, our Faculty of Engineering has executed strategic Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs) with leading tech enterprises, including Infosys, Advanced Electronics Systems, etc. bringing corporate training directly into our laboratories.

Our dedicated Placement and Training Cell works year-round to equip students with crucial technical expertise and soft communication skills. By hosting regular corporate immersion sessions, industrial visits, and Entrepreneurship Development Programmes, we encourage our youth to become job creators. Consequently, our final-year engineering and medical graduates routinely secure stellar practical training and corporate placements.

You are personally overseeing the infrastructural expansion of KBNU's sprawling 37-acre campus. What are the key physical transformations taking place?

A campus must inspire the minds that inhabit it. We are expanding our 37-acre infrastructure to create a vibrant, self-contained educational township. This includes IT-enabled smart classrooms, campus-wide high-speed Wi-Fi, and sophisticated laboratory spaces matching national standards.

Crucially, we have invested significantly in expanding the Khaja Bandanawaz Teaching & General Hospital, which is a massive 6-storey facility. We are developing it into a state-of-the-art healthcare hub for the entire Kalyana Karnataka region, complete with a newly upgraded casualty block, advanced ICUs, and 11 ultra-modern modular operation theatres integrated with telemedicine capabilities. This serves a dual purpose: it provides top-tier, highly affordable healthcare to the public, while giving our medical students unparalleled, real-world clinical exposure.

As an avid sportsman and cricketer, you have placed a distinct emphasis on athletic development. What sports infrastructure are you establishing on campus?

I firmly believe that the playground teaches vital values that the classroom cannot – namely teamwork, resilience, and discipline. Through the KBN House of Sports, we are developing a dedicated 14-acre sports complex featuring professional-grade cricket pitches and a stadium designed to host university-level tournaments.

Adjacent to it, we have established the KBN Riding Club, introducing equestrian sports to our students, which is a unique feature for a university campus in this geography. We want KBNU to be recognised equally for producing gold-medalist scholars and exceptional athletes capable of representing the state and country.

For a university to achieve true global standing, research must be institutionalised. What steps are you taking to foster innovation at KBNU?

Research is what transforms a consumer of knowledge into a creator of knowledge. We have institutionalised research by offering robust Ph.D. programmes across nearly all faculties – from Microbiology and Anatomy to Civil Engineering, Physics, and the Humanities.

We incentivise our faculty members to publish in high-impact, peer-reviewed international journals and to secure national research grants. We regularly host national workshops, such as our recent intensive sessions on Information & Cyber Security, and regional techno-management fests like Yukti, which allow students to present innovative models. We want KBNU to act as an analytical think-tank solving real-world technical and medical challenges specific to our geographic region.

KBNU is a primarily Minority managed institution, yet its doors are open to all. How does the university balance this status with its broader philanthropic mission?

The KBN University is built on the idea of Educating Humanity. As my father and grandfather always maintained, our philanthropic approach is rooted in compassion for the underprivileged sections of humanity, irrespective of caste, creed, or religion. Education is the ultimate social equaliser. We offer highly subsidised, structured fee formats across various courses to accommodate students from diverse socio-economic backgrounds. To give an illustration, a student pursuing a B.Sc. programme can access top-tier lab facilities at a very modest tuition fee starting around ₹18,000 per year. We provide extensive merit scholarships and fee concessions to ensure financial constraints never hinder a brilliant mind.

Your public profile is deeply elevated by your role as the Sajjada Nasheen – the spiritual head and custodian – of the magnificent shrine of Hazrat Khwaja Banda Nawaz Gesudaraz. How does this profound spiritual legacy guide your everyday decision-making across these high-stakes secular roles?

The position of Sajjada Nasheen is fundamentally a calling to serve humanity. Hazrat Khwaja Banda Nawaz Gesudaraz dedicated his entire life to Sulh-e-Kul – peace and harmony with all. He walked among the masses, spoke their local languages, broke bread with the impoverished, and taught that true devotion to God lies in relieving the suffering of a human heart.

When I sit in the Chancellor's office or chair a board meeting, I carry these exact values with me. To me, higher education, public administration, and spiritual custody are interconnected avenues of Khidmat (service). The spiritual energy of the Dargah reminds me daily that leadership must always be practiced with humility, absolute fairness, and deep empathy. Whether a citizen walks through the gates of our hospital seeking medical treatment or steps onto our campus seeking a career, our duty is to serve them with absolute dignity, mirroring the universal hospitality of the saint's open kitchen (Langar).

Dr Hussaini, what is your closing message to prospective students and families looking towards KBNU for their higher education journey?

KBNU is not just a place where you earn a degree; it is a space where you discover your potential. Whether you want to perform complex surgeries, design aerospace models, litigate landmark cases, or lead corporate boardrooms, we provide the tools, the infrastructure, and the mentorship to make it happen. Come to KBNU with an open mind and a passion to learn, and we will ensure you step out into the world as a confident, compassionate leader.





